REBOUND

Opening Memoir

Staging the Greatest Comeback Story of Life

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reboundbysol.com

Opening Memoir

To everyone who has been knocked down, broken by a season in life, counted out, or written off - this is your book.

Your story is not over. Your rebound begins here.

When life deals some of the harshest combinations of odds, and it feels as though you are locked in a drawback - when certain realities pose setbacks with almost no glimpse of hope for a comeback - you must realize at such times that, more often than not, 'the further backward an arrow is pulled, the further forward and upwards its velocity when released'.

This book is that proverbial release - from a drawback into a comeback.

Note this well: more often than not, a drawback is only a repositioning for a greater comeback. Like an arrow only launches forward after a pullback. That pullback you experienced was only a reset for your relaunch.

Get ready. Now that you have this book in your hands, something is about to shift within you that will make you look back and be glad you stayed the course.

Are you ready?

INTRODUCTION

The Fall Isn't the Finish Line

Every great story has a low point. The hero gets crushed, loses everything, doubts themselves, and then - against all odds - rises. This book is that rising.

Whether you lost a job opportunity, a relationship, a business, a career, a partner, your faith, a loved one, a marriage, your health, an investment, your reputation, or your sense of worth - I am here to tell you that the last of you hasn't been heard. it is not over! Your story is still being written.

I have experienced almost all of the situations mentioned above, and I am testament to what the human spirit is capable of overcoming. I am here today better for it.

That does not mean you must go through these things. It means that 'even though' you go through these things, you can thrive amid the storms. You can be refined amid the flames instead of getting scorched or totally burned.

Your response to life's situations is what will determine whether they 'break you' or 'make you'. You do not run away from it. You face it, brace it, and defy it. You do not respond with fear; you respond with fierce faith. You do not back down; you push through.

Simply put, it is all about your response when faced with compelling situations. What your core is made of eventually reveals itself in the middle of life's furnace. Is your core made of elements that turn to ash in the furnace? or made of elements that turn refined in fire, turn purified in the flames, shine brighter and emerge with added composite value after the furnace? Does your core disintegrate in fire or is refined in fire! Do you respond with fear - or you responds with stern faith in situations.

Like the poetically penned biblical text - the words of the warrior king: Though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I WILL FEAR NO EVIL. This book is that audacious cue to fear no evil. That audacious demeanor that projects a man who's core is made of fire, a man who defies fear, defies failure, defies setbacks and comes back stronger and better each time.

Fear is a torment only when you entertain it, but when you flip it around and do the exact opposite of what fear suggests, you cripple it. "I will fear no evil" is a deliberate statement of intent - targeted at crippling the force of fear that comes to cripple the force of life within you. Don't entertain it, reverse it and do what fear suggests you shouldn't do. Cripple fear!

I would not have written this book if I had entertained the fear of the depths of vulnerability it required to write a book of this importance. You won't be holding this book in your Hands now if I had allowed the tricks of fear to make me shut down the project. Several times I had reasons to shut it down, but I persevered because I knew the importance of its contents and the impact it would have on a life adrift in a storm somewhere around the globe.

When fear says you can't do it, you aren't qualified, aren't worthy, aren't good enough or aren't deserving; when fear says you will be turned down or rejected - at such moments that's when to rise and do the exact opposite of what that fear suggests. When fear says you cannot do it, that is the precise moment to go for it. Apply for that job. Send those emails. Start that project, send that mega bid proposal that suggests you are in delusions of grandeur. Besides, the greatest accomplishments documented in history all began with a tincture of delusion in them. Defy that fear.no matter how delusional your dream may seem. Believe, rise, and audaciously Win!

'That situation fear suggests is too big for you or out of your league,is the exact situation you should take-on fiercely and fearlessly.

There is no rebound without an audacious resolve to defy fear, own the moment, and defy the norm'.

The rebound process is universal. It is not magic. It is a path walked by leaders who took fallen nations back to pinnacles of power; by corporate executives and entrepreneurs who took bankrupt companies back to unimaginable fortunes; and by ordinary men and women who refused to back down or give up

on their lives, their dreams, their careers, their families, and their well-being.

Over the next fourteen chapters, I will take you on a journey that begins with a personal and very vulnerable piece of my own life's journey - how I almost lost my life but braced it, faced it, lived through it, overcame, found my own personal rebound, and today can share a bit of that life's journey with you.

Ultimately, I hope this inspires someone who might be at certain crossroads as I found myself back then, to keep pushing, persevere, and ultimately win.

After sharing a brief personal memoir in the opening chapters, the book moves into the Rebound Blueprint proper - a more empirical, step-by-step, chapter-by-chapter, battle-tested blueprint for anyone embarking on a rebound journey in their own life.

So to someone on the verge of giving up, or contemplating how they could ever navigate the impossible combinations of odds cast before them: this is your book. You will be spurred on, nudged forward, challenged, and provoked to go ahead and unapologetically take your throne and your life back.

You will learn exactly how to get up; believe in yourself; believe you are worthy of the best; believe you are the prize and that there is a crown on your head. Believe you are royal, beautiful, and deserving. Then - and only then - will you get yourself back together, stage the greatest comeback of your life, and take your throne.

This is not a day to give up. It is a day to win. And you must never give up on yourself - on any day, at any moment, at any given time.

This is not fluffy motivation. It is a battle-tested, life-tested, and time-tested empirical blueprint, drawn from the feedback of survivors, winners in the battles of life, and personal victories.

While I worked as an intake coordinator, interviewing survivors on their journeys to victory, I witnessed firsthand the strength of the human spirit in facing storms and overcoming them. I listened and saw that nothing was insurmountable in the presence of a determined and spirited being. I saw how the human spirit can persevere in dire, life-threatening situations and, with utter determination, overcome.

This book is not only from real-life experience. It is from proven truths, proven psychology, life's triumphs, biblical texts, and more broadly, excerpts from global winners in the arena of life. References are drawn from contemporary and historical analogies, present-day high performers, leaders who lost power but staged historic comebacks, families who lost loved ones but rose from the ashes to build stronger homes and better lives. Athletes, entrepreneurs, and everyday people who refused to stay down.

From the boardrooms to the classrooms, this is a pivotal book that will shift mindsets and rewire individuals, entire teams, and organizations - not to back down in any adverse circumstance.

So, expect mental exercises, mindset shifts, call-to-action steps, and real talk that is as audacious, unpretentious, thought-provoking, and action-inducing as can be.

I did not come with kid gloves. As a matter of fact, I came gloves off - because taking your life back; your emotional well-being, your health, your fitness and physical well-being; your finances, your spiritual and mental well-being; your self-esteem, social well-being, your value, love, and worth - taking these vital elements of your essence back is non-negotiable. I have been there. It is not a place to leave any human, or to leave anyone clueless about where to turn or what to do.

You do not need permission. You do not need perfect conditions. You do not need any more motivation or anyone's affirmation. You only need to decide - right now - that the rebound starts today. My name is Onu Sol Adah, and I am not your regular author.

Let's begin.

Chapter One

Stark Reality Tempest-torn, cast down - but not destroyed

The audacity to face reality - a brief memoir

The time is 4:25 p.m. Eastern Standard Time(EST) in Atlanta, and 10:25 p.m. Central African Time(CAT) in Nigeria.

Quickly, he glanced at the clock one more time. He has five minutes left to clock out of the day's work - clearing out his desk and about to send his End of Day Report. He prepares to log off for the night. His first week at a life-changing, seven-figure job: a nine-to-five with a U.S. firm, working remotely from Nigeria.

He thought of his family, his kids, and his loved ones, and how he could finally provide for them. "How odds quickly turn for good", he thought for a moment.

Emotions slowly starting to fill him - gratitude mixed with sadness; emotions from traumatic events of the past that he had overcome, and wishing some loved ones were still here so he could finally make up for the difficult times encountered together.

Sitting there at his desk, everything seemed okay in that moment. His life slowly piecing itself back together from the shattered fragments it had been a few months prior. He glanced at the clock one more time, sends his EOD report, and clocked out at exactly 4:30 p.m. EST - 10:30 p.m. Nigerian time. His two kids, ages five and ten, already asleep. He didn't get the chance to say his goodnights before bed, but that was fine. He was working to provide for them.

He sat at his desk for yet another moment to process the emotions pouring in - gratitude mixed with sad memories. 'How odds quickly turn', he thought again. It felt like an epic rebound movie emerging from some of the most traumatic seasons of life.

Motionless at his desk for yet another moment, the immediate past panned through. His world had literally crashed. He had lost everything he held dear - his career, his first job, his family, his friends, his dignity. Literally everything. He felt stripped of the least thing a man could boast of: the basic dignity and the right to life. The tidal storms that had shaken his world and threatened to take his life still traumatically panned through his mind.

As he sat there, he drifted into vivid flashbacks that reeled through his thoughts like a tragic movie.

He recalled...

In the cold, windy hours of an unforgettable night in August - shaky hands and trembling feet - standing outside the building where he had just received the unnerving and shattering news: the news that he

had been cut off from work; the traumatic loss of a life-saving employment. Standing there in the freezing weather, wondering how he was going to cope with everything.

The cold winds whistled over his face. Frozen in thought, trying to keep it together, too many thoughts surged through like a flood of hail over his mind - too many thoughts trying to drown him from within. But like the metaphorical duck on a pond - motionless on the surface, yet beneath the murky water its feet paddling hard to stay afloat - he worked his mind quickly for solutions.

He thought of the final eviction notice served a couple of weeks earlier and due that day. He thought of his two beautiful children at home with the babysitter. He thought of how he had lost his wife to the harshest economic circumstances they had ever faced.- He felt alone.

He glanced on, and the world before him felt hollow, empty, and cold.

"I have to get home quickly to the kids", he thought, as the urgency to be with them weighed heavier by the minute. He knew they depended on him, and he could not let them down.

The stark reality of the moment grew stronger by the second. Standing there in the middle of the night, in need of quick solutions in real time, it felt like a bolstering storm with no harbor in sight.

Quickly he hailed a cab. "Hills Avenue, please," he muttered to the driver. He got in and let out a deep sigh as he sank into the back seat.

"Cold night, sir?" the cab driver gestured in a friendly cab/passenger conversation.

"Yes - a cold night, and a cold world too," he muttered with all the honesty he could muster.

"Yes, cold world," the driver said, briefly glancing through the rearview mirror. Then, empathetically added: "Everything will be fine, sir."

The driver's words, as reassuring as they were intended, only succeeded in throwing up more traumatic memories. He had sadly heard those same words from a team of doctors concerning his loving mother: Everything will be fine - words the doctors eventually could not keep.

Subconsciously, as he sat in the back seat of that cab, his thoughts drifted deeper, recalling the sad incident with the doctors only a couple of weeks prior.

Another unforgettable night.

Chapter Two

Stark Reality II Another unforgettable night in August - a beautiful mother's memory

While the cab made its way to get him home, his thoughts reeled on.

Standing in the middle of that cold hospital room where the life-altering news from the team of surgeons had just shaken his world to its foundations - the life-altering news regarding his beautiful mother - his mind panned back to the words of the doctor the night of the surgery: "Everything will be fine". But that was never to be the case, sadly.

What a beauty she was, he thought of his mother for a moment. What an angel. What a light that shone from within her - a light put out that night and may never beam through again. Beautiful heavenly eyes that ever sparkled with kindness. A heart made of gold. Her presence literally lit up any room she walked into. Light-skinned beauty with radiant smiles like those of angels. You needed to have met her to quite understand that these weren't exaggerations.

He had never known anyone so beautiful, and never known anyone to love him as much as she did. She was a pillar to him - but not just to him. She was a pillar to all her children, and to everyone who ever met her. She would stand by you when no one else would. She would cover you when it seemed the world was up in arms against you. She would never give up on her own.

He watched her raise him as a child, shield him from the world at his lowest, and project him to the world at his greatest. She never backed down for a minute concerning all those she loved. If it were possible, he would literally have exchanged his life for hers. And yet there he was. It seemed he could not fight to save her life. That traumatized him in more indescribable ways than words could convey.

That night felt truly like rock bottom. It seemed his life went into freefall with no hope of a rebound.

Still held in riveting thought, he recalled how the lead surgeon tried to make sense of the aftermath of the surgery. In the attempt to make any sense, the surgeon explained "the angioplasty is the standard medical procedure for unclogging blocked arteries, using angiography and other world best practices". He further made attempts to justify that night as he stuttered intermittently. Obviously the consultant surgeon knew that his team had failed - not only did they fail, they made elementary procedural errors that even medical interns would not make.

The outcome of the surgery later showed that they had not followed standard preliminary medical procedures. The negligence was loud and heartbreaking. But then again, that is why they are human. We are all human after all. No one is perfect, regardless of the best training we get. We remain subject to our humanity and the frailty of it.

He recalled for a moment his plans to sue the hospital. But then - what good would that bring? It could not possibly bring back his beautiful mother. She was the extension of his Maker's love to him. And right there and then, all of that had changed in the twinkle of a moment.

The cab eventually pulled up at his residence. He was glad to be finally home to his children, yet fully aware of the mountainous hill ahead: the quit notice, the job loss, his children's welfare, the trauma of the losses in his life. The stark realities of the moment felt as palpable as could be.

He knew he had a high threshold for pain tolerance, but it seemed he was closing in on his limits under the avalanche of storms against him. Breaking down was not an option. He had to stay strong.

Chapter Three

Defying Adversity The audacity to defy adversity

The weeks that followed would be the most challenging of his life. He checked his family temporarily into a nearby hotel as a result of the quit notice. He gathered his savings and paid for as many days as those savings could afford, pending other accommodation arrangements.

Days turned into weeks, weeks into months. With his savings depleting quickly and no income coming in, the future and the days ahead felt like a foggy, winding labyrinth. It felt like freefall into the depths.

But faith broke the fall. And that uncanny intuition - explainable only as divine guidance - began charting a new path out of the dark alley. He began applying for jobs again online: on Upwork, Fiverr, and any job sites available. Armed with resilience, grit, and the undying will to overcome, faith and the fire of hope became his anchor within.

He started restrategizing, recalibrating, and rebuilding piece by piece. He would drop the children off at school, return to the hotel, and do more work online. Writing was a vent for his soul - a hobby that later proved lucrative. Writing humanitarian stories, journals, articles, music, and scripts for screenplays fueled his passion. He found a therapeutic outlet through it.

It was strange, because his university background stood in sharp contrast to writing. He came from an accounting and finance field - a field he had struggled so hard to fit into and couldn't ever quite fit into.

But writing was his forte. It stirred his passions and brought him more income in a quarter than an average accountant might earn in a year. Besides, it was more fulfilling than he could ever have dreamed. He turned to it every time he needed an escape from reality. He poured his soul onto ink and paper.

One of such articles he posted online about his bosom friend from way back at the university, who sadly passed away under very heartbreaking circumstances - caught the eyes of a U.S.-based law firm. At the time the firm was scouting globally for writers who could be part of their legal and humanitarian work at the firm, and his style of writing matched their search. They already had a pool of excellent writers, and needed him to join the team.

The rest is history. He was given an initial contract with the firm as a freelance writer. The following year he became a full nine-to-five staff with the firm in Atlanta. That changed his story. He found a rebound out of the murky economic waters that had flooded in to drown him. That job was the turning point and the rise out of rock bottom.

The weeks that followed the loss of his mother, the loss of his first job, the loss of his family, friends and support system were the most devastating weeks any man could find themselves in - it was an

avalanche of storms flooding in all at once, but resilience, grit, determination, and sheer courage in the face of adversity were the rebound fuel he needed to pull up out from under the rubble.

Often when life throws up a whirlwind of storms, or in moments of catastrophic downturn, the place hardest-hit by the storm is the mental well-being, then the emotional well-being, then followed closely by the spiritual well-being. From there the damage could begin a ripple effect unto the Social well-being, then the financial well-being, it slowly permeates the entire essence of the individual. That is always the end target and plot of the menace of storms.

However, when storms are audaciously combated with an equal and opposite resistance to give in, tenacity in the face of opposing realities, and an attitude of unyielding faith, then the human spirit begins to rise amid the storm and tenaciously ride on those same storms as springboard out of the valleys. The same avalanche of tidal events targeted at one soul becomes the fire that fuels the rise of that same soul.

Systematically, in his case scenario, he turned a season of depressive thoughts and isolation into a season of meditation and spiritual devotion - sharpening his mind, fueling his spirit. Bit by bit, he flooded life back into his soul: in meditation, in spiritual devotion, in engaging new passions, hiking, road walks, hitting the gym, deepening cognitive skills like divergent thinking, and honing his writing skills again. Any material that inspired the heart, soul, and spirit, he engaged - from comeback stories of the greatest who conquered impossible circumstances, to the acts of biblical kings and the wars they fought and won; from the history of modern nations that rose from near collapse to world dominance, to entrepreneurs who took bankrupt companies out of the shadows. He filled his spirit with life, greatness, fire, and light. And as they say: darkness always gives way where light is ushered in..

Writing provided that outlet and vent for his soul. He poured out his soul on paper like no writer he had ever read - pure, true, vulnerably authentic, and as audacious as can be.

Grief and losses of any kind can feel dense and irrecoverable sometimes, loss of a cherished relationship, a loved one, a career, money, or a business can be devastating and sometimes feel irrecoverable. But as you will discover from the pages of this book, You can recover, you can rise out of the loss and become the best version of yourself yet. When setbacks come in to break you deep within, the resilience to withstand it all and rise out of it is also deep within you at the same time.

Right within you, in the brokenness, lies the needed strength.

Hidden in the elements of the fall lie the elements of the rise. The fuel needed to propel your rebound upward is still found in the very force that seems to pull you downward.

Most importantly: the fire that threatens to disintegrate your world is the same fire needed to refine you before the world. The paradox of these battle-tested statements is agelessly incontestable.

For out of the eater came something to eat, and out of the strong came something sweet remains an incontestable biblical text - and one of my favorites because of its context. Its paradox fittingly forms the core of this book in many ways.

Out of the fire came refined gold. Out from the fall came an unstoppable rise.

There is a state of mind and audacity often possessed by great warriors: the audacity to snatch victory out from the jaws of defeat; the audacity to turn what came to destroy them into what eventually elevates them. And you must possess that stern audacity too - the audacity to turn what came to consume you into the consumed; to turn a story of tragedy into a story of victory; thereby achieving a rebound unto a greater, better, stronger, higher version of yourself. A never-backing-down, never-giving-up state of mind.

OUT OF THE FLASHBACKS

Eventually he drifted back from the sequence of flashbacks. It felt as though he had just journeyed through time and traveled through the past in a single moment. But it felt therapeutic to know he had gone through all these things and survived. It felt uplifting to know he had gone through it all and had not disintegrated, had not faltered off life.

Beating depression and overcoming was a victory greater than any.

He got his job back - a better offer that paid twice what the first lost job had paid (almost two million monthly in Nigerian naira). That was a lot of money for someone who had nothing and was coming out from rock bottom. He felt more grateful than words could convey.

He found strength through those weakest moments. He found purpose in the pain that those storms brought. And he found a voice within the same winds that had tried to silence him.

- End of Opening Memoir -